Chapter 10

FROM RESILIENCE TO RESURGENCE



"Hindu Marathas or Musalmans behave as per the traditions of their caste or community, do not discriminate against them. The kingdom should not discriminate on the basis of each person's faith or his deity."

- Nanasaheb Peshwa in 1761

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Describe the importance of Maharana Raj Singh in Bharat's fight against the Mughals
- Describe the Mughal-Rajput war and Mughal-Maratha war and their consequences
- Explain the expansion of Marathas under Peshawas
- Examine the causes and consequences of the Third Battle of Panipat

Orange House
Your Knowledge Partner

INTRODUCTION

Seventeenth century Bharat suffered unprecedented religious persecutions and tyranny at the hands of the Mughal Emperor Aurangzeb. Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj challenged Aurangzeb and successfully established the Maratha Empire in 1674. During the same time, Maharana Raj Singh of Sisodia dynasty, the fourth generation successor of Maharana Pratap of Mewar was on a campaign against the Mughals in Rajputana. Raj Singh's successful missions and Shivaji's vision brought about the end of Mughals in the next few decades.

RAJPUTS - RESISTANCE CONTINUES

SISODIAS AFTER RANA PRATAP

After the death of Maharana Pratap during a hunting expedition, his son Amar Singh became the ruler of Mewar in 1597. He was a valorous king and a worthy successor of Maharana Pratap. After Akbar, his son Jahangir made several attempts to conquer Mewar. But Amar Singh remained undefeated. Mughals were forced to make a treaty with Mewar in 1615. After decades of warfare, peace and order got restored in Mewar under **Amar Singh**. Amar Singh's successors Karan Singh and Jagat Singh made several administrative reforms and strengthened the defense. Mewar prospered. Jagat Singh's son **Maharana Raj Singh** ascended the throne in 1652. In 1658, Aurangzeb arrested his father, killed his brothers and occupied the Mughal throne.



Maharana Amar Singh



Maharana Raj Singh

RAJ SINGH'S ONSLAUGHT ON MUGHALS

Destruction of temples, imposition of Jizya and mass conversion of Hindu men and enslavement of Hindu women by Aurangzeb irked Raj Singh. He decided to take the Mughals head-on. He ravaged the Mughal posts and took them under his control. He defied Aurangzeb by not paying Jizya. Raj Singh attacked and conquered states that were under Mughal authority. He then moved out of Rajputana and raided the regions in Gujarat and Malwa.

THINK!!!

When Aurangzeb demanded Jizya from Shivaji Maharaj, he challenged the Badshah to first attempt collecting Jizya from Maharana Raj Singh. If the Rana paid, he was willing to oblige. Imagine how audacious Raj Singh must have been that a tyrant like Aurangzeb feared him.

RAJ SINGH RESCUES CHARUMATI

Kishangarh was a small village near Mewar ruled by Roop Singh. He had an extremely beautifiul daughter named Charumati. When the fame of her beauty reached the ears of Aurangzeb, he ordered Charumati's family members to get her married to him. Fearing Aurangzeb, Roop Singh accepted. But Charumati firmly rejected the proposal. Since she did not receive any help from her family, she wrote to Rana Raj Singh and sought to marry him. Upon knowing this, Raj Singh decided to rescue the girl. He commanded one of his generals Ratan Singh to intercept the Mughal army that was approaching Kishangarh to take away Charumati. Raj Singh rescued Charumati and married her.

HADI RANI

While on his mission to rescue Charumati, Ratan Singh did not focus on the war since he was always thinking of his newly married wife Hadi Rani. He sent emissaries to his wife and asked her to send some gift as a token of her love and memory. On two occasions the Rani gave her ring and her fragrant handkerchief. When the third emissary came, she realised that her husband was engrossed in thinking about her and was not focused on the war. She knew that it was a crucial war, and Rana Raj Singh's safety rested in defending the invaders. She decided to change Ratan's attitude. She instructed her attendants to take her severed head as a gift in a plate covered by a red cloth and beheaded herself. The plate was delivered to Ratan Singh. He opened it he was shocked to see Hadi Rani's severed head. He understood the message and got ready for the final assault. Free from all bondage, Ratan went on a rampage and decimated the army before laying down his life. The resistance he posed, offered the time needed for Raj Singh to rescue Charumati.

RAJ SINGH RESCUES SHRINATHJI

Aurangzeb issued an order to the priests of the famous Srinathji temple at Mathura - that they should demonstrate a miracle of the Lord to prove the Lord's divinity. He threatened to destroy the temple and break the Lord's murthi if they failed. The priests decided to shift the murthi away from Mathura and requested Rana Raj Singh's support in offering shelter. Inspite of knowing that it would invite Aurangzeb's wrath, Raj Singh readily accepted to offer state protection to the Lord. On hearing this, Aurangzeb got furious and wrote to Raj Singh, forbidding him from giving protection to the Lord and the priests. He warned of dire consequences. Raj Singh completely ignored the threat and offered a village near Udaipur to the priests



Lord Shrinathji

to reinstall Srinathji. He mobilized a huge army to defend the new temple and also sought the support of neighboring kings. Aurangzeb didn't dare to engage in a war with Mewar.

RAJ SINGH RESCUES AJIT SINGH

Marwar was the neighbouring kingdom of Mewar. The kings of Marwar remained loyal to the Mughals since the times of Akbar. When Raj Singh was the ruler of Mewar, Marwar was under Jaswant Singh. At the time of his death in 1678, Jaswant Singh had no living heirs, but soon, his wife gave birth to a son posthumously*. Marwar was without a ruler. Aurangzeb exploited the situation and moved Jaswant Singh's family to Delhi. He wanted to convert them to Islam and acquire the kingdom of Marwar. **Veer Durgadas Rathore**, a noble in the kingdom of Marwar, rose up to the occasion and decided to rescue the infant, Ajit Singh. In a series of guerilla wars, covert operations and death-defying encounters with the Mughals, Durgadas managed to handover the infant to Raj Singh and sought his protection. Raj Singh readily accepted to shelter Ajit Singh and swore to protect him, leaving Aurangzeb fuming.

DEFEAT OF AURANGZEB

Raj Singh's rescue of Charumati, Shrinathji and Ajit Singh infuriated Aurangzeb. He mobilized a huge army and attacked Mewar in 1679. Raj Singh appealed to all Rajputs kings to support him in his mission of defending Mewar. He was joined by Vanavasi groups like Bhils and Pulindas. Raj Singh escorted the people of Udaipur to a safe hilly zone and adopted scorched-earth policy. The Mughal army was starved and was further surprised by guerilla warfare used by the Rana. Aurangzeb after a failed campaign left Mewar and retracted to Ajmer. A frustrated Aurangzeb decided for an all-out offensive. He sent 3 separate armies, under his sons Akbar, Azam and Muazzam and led one himself. They penetrated the Aravalli hills from different directions. However, the unfamiliar hilly terrains made the Mughal artillery ineffective. The Mughal forces were dragged into the hills and ravaged by the defending Mewar army. The Mughals suffered serious setbacks and depleted their treasury in a year-long unsuccessful campaign. The combined army of Mewar and Marwar totally decimated Aurangzeb. Maharana Raj Singh had also fulfilled the promise of protecting Ajit Singh

BATTLE OF UDAIPUR AND ARAVALLI	
When? 1679 – 1680	
Where? Udaipur, Mewar (Rajasthan)	
Who were the combatants?	
Mughals	Kingdom of Mewar
Who were the commanders?	
Aurangzeb & his sons	Raj Singh & his sons, Durgadas Rathore
Outcome : Mewar Victory	
SIGNIFICANCE : Depletion of Mughal treasure and continuing sovereignty of Mewar	



Udaipuri, wife of Aurangzeb, accompanied him during the war. In the chaos of war, she was captured by Mewar soldiers. She was taken to the Rana who received her with honor and dignity and sent her back to Aurangzeb safely. Invaders dishonored women captured in war and made them slaves. While Hindu kings treated women with honor.

NATIONAL LOSS AND AN EPIC RESISTANCE

Misfortune struck Bharat in 1680. Unable to subdue Raj Singh through wars, Aurangzeb resorted to wile*. He bribed a few people inside the Mewar court to poison Raj Singh. Raj Singh fell to the treachery and died in 1680. In the same year, Shivaji Maharaj passed away leaving behind his 28 year old son **Sambhaji** as the next Chhatrapati. Death of the two great kings in the same year left a deep void in Bharat's resistance against the tyrannical regime of Aurangzeb. However, they had created enough spirit and conviction in the minds of their successors. For the next 3 decades, the successors of Shivaji and Raj Singh waged relentless wars against the Mughals.

Posthumous : After the death of someone **Wile :** Cunning strategy

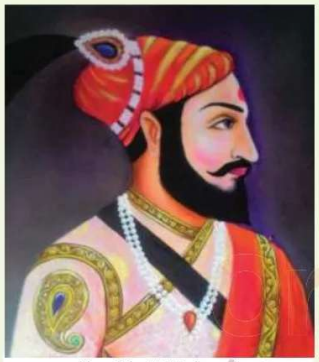
MUGHAL - RAJPUT WARS

After the death of Raj Singh, Aurangzeb managed to make peace with Mewar. But Marwar continued to battle under the leadership of Durgadas Rathore from 1680. He won many key battles forcing Mughals to retreat. In 1686 Mughals governor of Gujarat and Jodhpur led a campaign against Marwar but was defeated. Political situation reversed in Marwar as Mughals were forced to pay tribute to Marwar. Durgadas continued his resistance until Aurangzeb's death in 1707. After 1707, Durgadas launched another campaign to completely evict the Mughals from Marwar. **Ajit Singh** became the Maharaja of Jodhpur in 1710 and rebuilt all the temples that had been desecrated by the occupying Muslims. At the end of 3 decades of war, the Mughals gained nothing. They lost thousands of lives and enormous sums of money and the Mughal empire collapsed.

MUGHAL – RAJPUT WARS	
When? 1679 - 1707	
Where? Rajputana	
Who were the combatants?	
Mughals	Kingdom of Marwar & Mewar
Who were the commanders?	
Aurangzeb & his sons	Ajit Singh, Durgadas Rathore & many
Outcome : Rajput Victory	
SIGNIFICANCE : **Collapse of Mughal Empire**	

MUGHAL – MARATHA WARS

SAMBHAJI'S VALOUR


Sambhaji Maharaj

After the death of Shivaji Maharaj in 1680, his 28 year son Sambhaji became the next Chhatrapati. Aurangzeb decided to use all his might to crush the Marathas. In 1681, Aurangzeb camped at Aurangabad with 5,00,000 strong army to capture the Maratha Empire. It was a disproportionate war in all senses. However Sambhaji faced the opponent with valor. The Mughal forces laid siege to Fort Ramsej, Nashik. But the Marathas did not succumb to the onslaught. They resisted the attack for seven years, much to the annoyance of Aurangzeb. Between 1681 and 1688 the Marathas under Sambhaji fought more than 60 battles successfully. Unfortunately Chhatrapati Sambhaji was captured and arrested in February 1689 and taken before Aurangzeb. Aurangzeb offered to let Sambhaji free if he agreed to convert to Islam. However, Sambhaji refused to do so. He was cruelly tortured for 14 days and then beheaded. To Aurangzeb, it seemed to be the end of Marathas. But the brutal killing of Sambhaji kindled the spirit of the Marathas.

WAR CONTINUES

Sambhaji's son was just 7 years old and hence Chhatrapati Shivaji's second son Rajaram took over the throne in 1689. In 1690 Aurangzeb laid siege to Raigad fort. Marathas resisted the siege exasperating* the Mughal forces. However, Aurangzeb managed to capture the fort by bribing the caretaker of the fort. **Yesubai** (Sambhaji's wife) and her son **Shahu** were captured. Anticipating the fall of Raigad, **Raja Rajaram** along with the Maratha minister **Ramchandra Pant Amatya** moved to Panhala. From Panhala Rajaram reached Jinji, Tamilnadu in 1691. Rajaram's escape from Panhala to Tamilnadu was an ambitious plan since most of the places en-route were under the Mughal control.

Aurangzeb was highly annoyed that Rajaram had escaped right under the nose of Mughal forces. So he despatched an army of 25,000 soldiers to lay siege to Jinji. Marathas expected this move and appointed Ramchandra Pant and Shankaraji Pant Sachiv to defend from south. The defense from the north was planned by two of the able Maratha commanders **Santaji Ghorpade** and **Dhanaji Jadhav**. The two commanders launched several flash raids on Mughal tents causing havoc to the Mughal army. After a 7 year siege, Jinji was finally captured by the Mughals. But it had significantly depleted Mughal resources in the region, from the

Exasperate : Intensely irritate

treasury to material. Also, the capture of Jinji proved futile as Rajaram had already escaped to Vishalgadh in 1699. Aurangzeb realised that the war he had started was much more serious than he had originally thought. Not heeding to the advice of many Mughal ministers to abandon the mission of conquering the Marathas, Aurangzeb remained adamant.

TARABAI LEADS THE MARATHAS


Rani Tarabai

In 1700 Rajaram died. Rajaram's wife **Rani Tarabai** through her astuteness* installed her son **Shivaji II** on the throne and became the queen regent to govern the Marathas. The period between 1700 and 1707 was navigated by Tarabai with sound military and civil strategy. Tarabai had been trained in defence and government matters and quickly established her mark.

Although she was short handed in terms of her armies, she made quick attacks on the regions under Mughal control. Fearless, Tarabai stretched the borders of the Maratha empire by attacking Guna (in Madhya Pradesh) and Berar and Telangana. Even cities in Gujarat and Khandesh were not left alone. Revenue collectors were put in place to ensure that the Maratha treasury was funded by these conquests.

DID YOU KNOW?

Khafi Khan, a Mughal chronicler, wrote about Tarabai, "She was a clever, intelligent woman, and had obtained a reputation during her husband's lifetime for her knowledge of civil and military matters."

END OF AURANGZEB AND COLLAPSE OF MUGHALS

Around 1705, without losing any major territory in the Deccan the Marathas had managed to defeat the Mughals. The guerilla warfare tactics of the Marathas, their persistent spirit to rid Bharat of the invaders were effective and brought down the large armies of Aurangzeb. Aurangzeb made his way back to Ahmadnagar (about 120 km from Pune) where he reached his "journey's end". More than 25 years of his life was consumed in the Deccan campaign. The Mughal empire was in shambles, its treasury depleted and power structures and influence destroyed. Chhatrapati Shivaji and the Marathas had brought down Aurangzeb and the Mughals.

Aurangzeb died in February 1707.

MUGHAL - MARATHA WARS	
When? 1680 - 1707	
Where? Present-day Maharashtra, Gujarat, Madhyapradesh, Karnataka & Tamilnadu	
Who were the combatants?	
Mughal Empire	Maratha Empire
Who were the commanders?	
Aurangzeb, his sons, Zulfiqar Khan	Sambhaji, Rajaram, Tarabai and many
Outcome : Maratha Victory	
SIGNIFICANCE : Collapse of Mughal Empire	

DID YOU KNOW?

Manucci, a European, spent long years during this time in Bharat and chronicled the events of the period. He writes:

"Aurangzeb withdrew to Ahmadnagar, leaving behind him the fields of these provinces devoid of trees and bare of crops, their places being taken by the bones of men and beasts. Instead of greenery all is black and barren. The country is so desolated that neither fire nor light can be found in the course of three or four days' journey. There have died in his armies over a hundred thousand souls yearly, and of animals, pack-oxen, camels, elephants, etc., over three hundred thousand. In the Deccan provinces from 1702 to 1704 plague (and famine) prevailed. In these two years there expired over two millions of souls"

Astuteness : Intelligence to assess situations and people

RANI YESUBAI SAVES SHAHU

A succession war started between Aurangzeb's sons Azam Shah, Shah Alam and Kam Buksh after Aurangzeb's death. Azam Shah had possession of the Maratha royals Yesubai and Shahu with whom he was keen to travel back to Delhi. While they were in Bhopal Yesubai didn't want Shahu to spend his time in a remote Delhi jail. She negotiated with Azam Shah and got Shahu released. Yesubai with a few other royals were taken to Delhi and their custody changed hands to Shah Alam as Azam Shah was defeated by Shah Alam.

RISE OF THE PESHWAS

POWER WAR

Raja Shahu started assuming power and most ministers and generals sided with him taking over the throne. There however existed a power centre around Tarabai as well. The power of these two royals were centered around Satara and Kolhapur. Battles were fought within the Marathas and Tarabai lost a few of them along with some of her loyal generals. Between 1701 and 1713, Shahu was faced with challenges from Tarabai and the Mughals. However, by 1713 most power rested with Shahu and Tarabai was deposed.

PESHWA BALAJI VISHWANATH CREATES ALLIANCES

Shah Alam was trying to make use of the internal rivalries among the Marathas. However, Shahu had an able administrator in **Peshwa Balaji Vishwanath** who brought together a loyal and effective team to ensure that Shah Alam didn't exploit the situation. In just 7 years the Peshwa was able to stitch many alliances that cemented Maratha power. The Maratha kingdom was made up of many regions under different Maratha commanders. Balaji stabilized the entire kingdom by signing treaties with the various commanders in return for supporting Shahu with armies and taxes. The people who didn't cooperate were removed.

In the Deccan, the Peshwa entered into an agreement with the Mughal viceroy Husain Ali. The Marathas required artillery and Husain Ali wanted to overthrow Farukh Siyar who had taken the throne in Delhi.

Husain Ali along with Peshwa Balaji Vishwanath and the Maratha forces marched towards Delhi. They owerpowered Faruksiyar, imprisoned him and freed Rani Yesubai and other members of Maratha family in 1718. They also installed Rafi-ud-Darjat as a puppet ruler and signed a treaty with him.

TREATY BETWEEN MUGHALS AND MARATHAS

- Release of all Maratha prisoners including the Maratha royal family
- Recognition of the independent Swarajya founded by Chhatrapati Shivaji
- Right for Marathas to collect Chauthai (25% of total revenue) and Sardeshmukhi (10% of total revenue) in all 6 Deccan provinces.

The Marathas in return agreed to :

- Recognize the nominal authority of the Mughal emperor
- Maintain an army in Deccan to keep the peace
- Maintain 15,000 troops to protect the Mughal throne

Historian G. S. Sardesai notes that when a sovereign (Mughal) seeks protection from a vassal (Marathas), it means that in actual practice the comparative strength of the two parties is reversed. That is, the Marathas had now become protectors of the Mughals.

Queen Yesubai, Raja Shahu's mother, and the Maratha royals were released and brought by the Peshwa and the Maratha army to Satara. Raja Shahu personally received his mother who had spent more than 30 years in

captivity. Rani Yesubai had earned the respect and admiration of her people. She had protected the heir to the Maratha throne, endured and navigated her way in captivity and advised her child and the other royals to lead a life of Dharma.

PESHWA BAJI RAO I EXPANDS THE MARATHA EMPIRE


Peshwa Baji Rao

In April 1720, Peshwa Balaji Vishwanath passed away. In about 15 days, Raja Shahu was looking for his next Peshwa and he didn't have to look far. There were many contenders for the post of Peshwa but 19-year-old **Baji Rao**, son of Balaji Vishwanath, staked his claim to the position. While the other contenders and ministers didn't think Baji Rao will even stand a chance, Shahu made Baji Rao the next Peshwa.

BAJI RAO OVERCOMES CHALLENGES

Soon after becoming the Peshwa, Baji Rao I faced multiple threats, both internal and external. Senior ministers who were unhappy about Baji Rao's appointment as the Peshwa, refused to cooperate with him. There was also a threat of Maratha Empire being taken over by Sambhaji II. Maratha Kingdom also had external threats from Nizam of Hyderabad, Portuguese in Goa, Siddhis of Janjira. Baji Rao recognized these threats. He adopted military and diplomatic strategies and overcame them.

Having resolved the internal and external threats, Baji Rao now embarked on this next agenda.

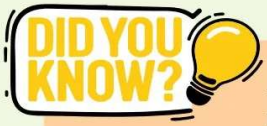
BAJI RAO EYES DELHI

Peshwa Baji Rao was keen to free Bharat from the foreign forces and prevent future foreign invasions. He understood the importance of establishing bases in the northern parts of Bharat. He planned to expand northwards. He led successful campaigns to Bhopal, Gujarat, Malwa. He also extended support to Maharaja Chatrasal of Bhundelkhand who as a young boy was inspired by Shivaji Maharaj. With Bhundelkhand under Baji Rao's control he set his eyes on Delhi. In 1737, Baji Rao undertook a mission to Delhi and defeated the Mughals decisively. Humiliated by the loss, the Mughal emperor sought the support of their vassals-Nizams of Hyderabad, Bhopal and Awadh. The combined army challenged Baji Rao at Bhopal which Baji Rao decimated.

From Delhi to Karnataka and from Gujarat to Berar were now under the Marathas.



Extant of Maratha empire during Baji Rao I



After Baji Rao had left Delhi and defeated the Nizam, he had to engage his army in Vasai. Seeing the Mughal's weakness, Nadir Shah of Iran invaded Delhi in 1739. He burnt down Delhi, looted the treasures, reinstalled Muhammad Shah as the emperor and left with an untold amount of wealth.

PASSING AWAY OF BAJI RAO

In April 1740, while on a campaign with his soldiers, Baji Rao passed away in Raverkhedi by the banks of the river Narmada after a brief illness. He was just a few months less than forty years. In the words of Sir

Richard Temple, "He died as he lived, in camp under canvas among his men, and he is remembered to this day among the Marathas as the fighting Peshwa and the incarnation of Hindu energy."

DID YOU KNOW?

Peshwa Baji Rao fought over 41 battles and never lost one!

MARATHAS AFTER BAJI RAO

Peshwa Baji Rao's sudden demise led to confusion regarding his successor. **Balaji Baji Rao** also known as **Nana Saheb** was the eldest son of Baji Rao and had been groomed to govern and administer by his uncle Chimaji Appa, mother and grandmother. Chhatrapati Shahu made Nana Saheb the next Peshwa in June 1740. This was not liked by people like Raghuji Bhosle, the Raja of Nagpur.

Nana Saheb had spent most of his time in diplomatic missions, difficult negotiations and governance more than fighting battles. Since taking over as Peshwa, Nana Saheb effectively started consolidating Maratha power across Bharat. Malwa was taken over from Sawai Jai Singh. The next few years till 1747 were spent in Bundelkhand and Bengal ensuring the regions were paying their tributes and Maratha power was consolidated.

NANA SAHEB, ARCHITECT OF PUNE CITY

Nana Saheb was a pioneer in developing the city of Pune. He started with a high wall around the core of the city for its protection that is seen even today. He encouraged artisans, traders and others to make the city their home. For this he expanded the living area (called 'peths') of the city.



Water scarcity was a major problem in Pune. The streams dried up in summer and people living away from the streams didn't have easy access to water. Dams were constructed on the Ambhil stream. Nana Saheb constructed a lake 13 miles away from Pune at Katraj which was in hilly terrain. This served as a catchment area for the water. Water then flowed down to another lake for more storage. Stone pipelines took water from these lakes to the city. This provided more than 26 lakh litres of water to the city.



MARATHA RESISTANCE OF DURRANIS

ATTROCITIES OF DURRANI

In 1752, Wazir Safdarjung in Delhi and the Nawab of Awadh requested the Marathas to help them drive out the Afghani Rohillas. The Marathas accepted the plea and drove away the Rohilla Pathans successfully. The responsibility of protecting the Mughal ruler in Delhi from internal and external enemies fell into the hands of the Marathas. In return, the right to collect tribute from all the major Mughal territories were given to the Marathas. The Rohillas wanting to take revenge on the Marathas invited Ahmad Shah Durrani (Abdali) of Afghanistan to defeat the Marathas. In October 1756, Ahmad Shah Durrani (Abdali) entered Bharat capturing Lahore on the way and reached Delhi. Ahmad destroyed Delhi completely and looted its entire wealth. From Delhi, he headed to the Hindu pilgrim sites of Mathura and Vrindavan. In Vrindavan, Ahmad slaughtered the innocent pilgrims, and the water of the Yamuna ran red. Every head brought by an Afghan soldier was given ₹ 5 as bounty. After this massacre Ahmad moved back to Afghanistan leaving Najib Khan to take care of Delhi.

CAPTURE OF DELHI

The Mughal emperor requested the Marathas to help them get rid of Abdali's agent Najib Khan. Peshwa Balaji Baji Rao sent his brother Raghunath Rao along with many other commanders and a large army towards Delhi. They were accompanied by Malhar Rao Holkar of Malwa. After two weeks of intense warfare, the Najib surrenderd and was arrested. The Marathas became the de-facto* rulers of Delhi.

MARATHA POWER AT ITS ZENITH

After the capture of Delhi, the Mughal general at Punjab, Adina Beg Khan, requested the Marathas to protect them from the menace of Afghan-Rohilla forces. Raghunath Rao accepted and joined hands with Adina Beg and Sikh misls which were already in revolt against Ahmad Shah Abdali. Marathas defeated the Afghans and captured Attock, Peshawar and Multan in 1759. The Maratha Empire was now at its largest-from Attock to Cuttack and from the Cauvery to the base of the Himalayas!

Abdali raided Bharat again wanting to overthrow Marathas and re-captured Attock. However, the Maratha and Sikh armies mobilized a huge army at Lahore in 1759. In a fierce battle that ensued the Afghans were defeated by the combined forces of the Marathas and the Sikh misl.



Map showing extant of Maratha empire at its zenith in 1759 CE

THIRD BATTLE OF PANIPAT

PRELUDE TO THE WAR

Unable to come in terms with the defeat at Lahore, Abdali marched towards Delhi with a massive army of more than 75,000 soldiers. On the way, Durrani attacked and captured the provinces captured earlier by the Marathas–Attock, Peshawar, Lahore and others and reached Delhi and took over Delhi from the Marathas. On receiving news about Ahmad's taking over of Delhi, Nana Saheb wrote to the other rulers, including the Rajputs and Jats, that Durrani shouldn't be allowed to grow roots in Bharat. The atrocities committed by Durrani including the massacres at Vrindavan and Mathura were widely known. By November 1760 the Maratha forces on one side and the forces of Ahmad Shah camped near Panipat. There were negotiations and talks between the two sides. But everything failed.

THE BATTLE

On 14 January 1761, the two sides clashed. **Sadashiv Rao Bhau** and **Vishwas Rao** (Nana Saheb's son) led the charge on the Maratha side. The first half of the day was in favour of the Marathas as the Rohillas and the Afghans suffered major losses. However, by afternoon the tides turned. Vishwas Rao was hit by a stray bullet and he died. This led to a huge loss of morale for the Marathas. Before the war, about 2000 Afghan soldiers had surrendered to the Marathas. These Afghans were employed to work on the Marathas side. However, this entire unit switched their loyalty and started killing the Marathas. All this added to the confusion among the Maratha ranks that started splintering. Ahmad Shah Durrani ordered his men to go on a rampage slaughtering all the people in the vicinity of Panipat. Thousands of men were beheaded and their skulls heaped outside their tents. Many thousands of women were taken captive. Sadashiv Rao Bhau, Jankoji Scindia and the other major warriors were killed. The huge loss of Maratha lives ensured a break in the chain of attacks from the northwest.

De-facto : In reality



THINK!!!

What is the distance between Pune and Panipat? 1600 km

How much time will it take to cover this distance by foot? 12 days non stop.

Imagine an army of 1 Lakh soldiers marching from Pune to Panipat just so that enemy can be prevented from entering mainland Bharat. This was the patriotic fervor of the Marathas.

OUTCOME

Although Abdali won the battle, the ground situation remained the same as he lost tens of thousands of soldiers. Having seen the spirit of resilience in the Marathas, he was not confident that he could establish his empire in Bharat. He decided to retreat back to Afghanistan. Abdali made peace with the Marathas and blamed Najib and others for a catastrophic war at Panipat.

BATTLE OF PANIPAT - III	
When? 1761	
Where? Panipat, near Delhi	
Who were the combatants?	
Marathas	Durranis
Who were the commanders?	
Balaji Bajirao, Sadashivarao Bhau	Ahmad Shah Durrani
Outcome : Pyrrhic victory of Durrani.	
SIGNIFICANCE : Marathas lose their hold over north of Sutlej. Durrani retreats to Afghan	

MARATHAS BOUNCE BACK

In spite of the loss at Panipat, the Marathas recovered quickly. After Balaji Bajirao, **Sawai Madhavrao I** became the Peshwa. He led the Marathas back to glory by unifying the different factions of the Marathas. He recognized the contributions of the leaders of these factions and involved them to expand the Maratha territories. He sent generals such as Bhonsle, Scindia and Holkar to the north, where they re-established Maratha authority by the early 1770s.

CONCLUSION

Bharat saw a thousand years of invasion from Arab, Turkey, Iran and Afghanistan. These ruthless and barbaric invaders slaughtered masses, destroyed and plundered our temples, enslaved women and children. They brought about great peril to Bharat. Any society that underwent such a devastation by foreign nations would have lost its native culture and civilization. But great kings and queens of this land fearlessly took on the invaders. They fought with them till their last breath and ensured that Bharat retained its cultural and civilizational identity. The resilient spirit of Maharana Pratap, the vision of Shivaji Maharaj, the tenacity of Guru Gobind Singh ensured that their successors carried on with their mission of resisting the invaders and purging them from Bharat. The non-stop warfare for over 25 years waged by the Marathas and the Rajputs brought the downfall of the Mughal empire and ensured the establishment of Hindavi Swaraj envisioned by Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj.

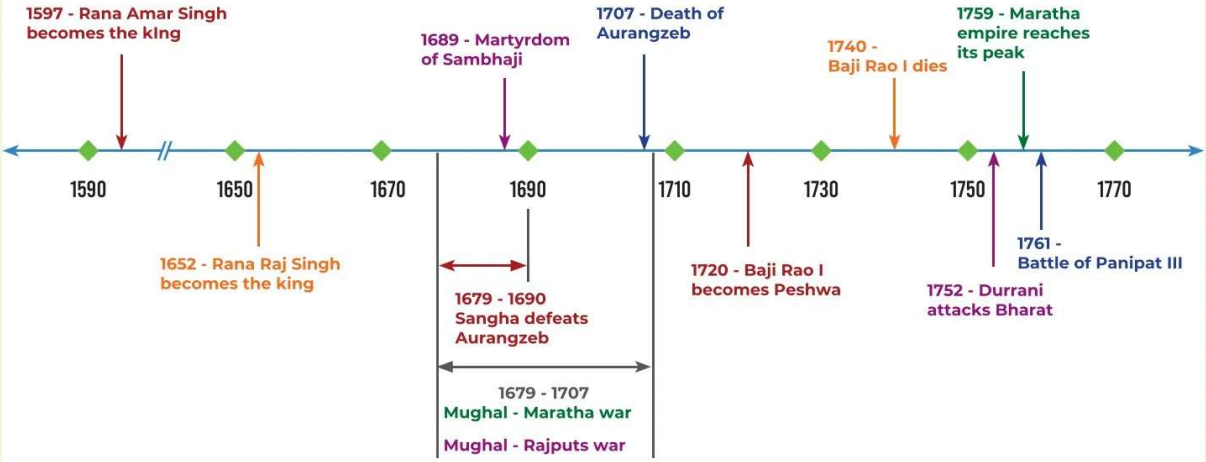
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KEYWORDS

- Rana Amar Singh
- Rana Raj Singh
- Durgadas Rathore
- Hadi Rani
- Jizya
- Mughal - Maratha war
- Mughal - Rajput war
- Sambhaji
- Rajaram
- Tara Bai
- Peshwa Balaji Viswanath
- Peshwa Baji Rao
- Peshwa Balaji Bajirao
- Ahmad Shah Durrani
- Battle of Panipat

RECAP WITH TIMESCALE



QUESTIONS

MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS

1. _____ succeeded Maharana Pratap to the Mewar throne.
   a) Amar Singh b) Prith Singh c) Raj Singh d) Roop Singh
2. In 1658, _____ ascended the Mughal throne.
   a) Akbar b) Jahangir c) Raj Singh d) Aurangazeb
3. True or False
   Statement A: Rana Raj Singh paid jizya when ordered by Aurangazeb.
   Statement B: Rana Raj Singh succeeded Karan Singh to the throne of Mewar.
   a) A alone is true b) B alone is true c) A & B are false d) A & B are true
4. Raj Singh was joined by Vanavasi groups like _____ and _____
   a) Munda and Baduga b) Chenchu and Kodaba c) Bhils and Pulindas d) Khasi and Gharo
5. In 1680, _____ succeeded Shivaji to the Maratha empire.
   a) Rajaram b) Sambhaji c) Tukoji d) Tanhaji
6. _____ was installed as a puppet ruler in Delhi by Peshwa Balaji VIshwanath.
   a) Rafi-ud-Darjat b) Rafi-ud-Daulat c) Husain Ali d) Hyder Ali
7. Baji Rao I was _____ years old when he became the Peshwa of Raja Shahu.
   a) 24 b) 17 c) 29 d) 19
8. _____ invaded Delhi in 1739 and reinstalled Muhammad Shah as the emperor.
   a) Peshwa Baji Rao b) Manucci c) Nadir Shah d) Alam Shah

ANSWER BRIEFLY

1. Who was Hadi Rani?
2. For how long did the siege of Jinji last?
3. Write about the fearless Rani Tarabai.
4. What were the challenges faced by Peshwa Baji Rao I.

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5. Describe the last days of Peshwa Baji Rao I.
6. Who was Ahmad Shah Durrani?

ANSWER IN DETAIL

1. How was Veer Durgadas Rathore helped by Raj Singh?
2. Elaborate on the battle of Udaipur and Aravalli and its final outcome.
3. How did Sambhaji meet his end?
4. Describe the events that led to the siege of Jinji.
5. Explain the role of Rani Yesubai in helping the Marathas consolidate power.
6. Describe the third battle of Panipat.
7. Why was Peshwa Balaji Vishwanath considered an able administrator? Explain with examples..
8. Explain the conditions of the treaty between the Marathas and Mughals after 1718 CE.
9. Peshwa Nana Saheb - a visionary. Explain.
10. Why did the Afghani Rohillas want to take revenge on the Marathas?

CASE STUDY

He sent 3 separate armies, under his sons Akbar, Azam and Muazzam and led one himself. They penetrated the Aravalli hills from different directions. However, the unfamiliar hilly terrains made the Mughal artillery ineffective.

1. With whom were the Mughals fighting against?
2. What happened to the Mughal armies?

REARRANGE THE EVENTS IN CHRONOLOGICAL ORDER

1. a) Tarabai leads the Marathas
   b) Aurangazeb dies
   c) Sambhaji is captured
   d) Raj Singh ascends the throne
2. a) Rajaram ascends the throne
   b) Ahmad Shah Durrani attacks Bharat
   c) Nana Saheb becomes Peshwa
   d) Battle of Udaipur and Aravalli

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MATCH THE FOLLOWING

Siddis	European
Chhatrapati Shivaji	Allies of Aurangzeb
Maucci	Maratha's royals
Yesubai Shahu	Father of Sambhaji

MAP WORK

1. Mark the following places : Guna, Bhopal, Malwa, Attock.
2. Mark the places travelled by Raja Rajaram during his escape from Raigad
3. Mark the extent of the Maratha empire at the end of Peshwa Baji Rao I's time.
4. Mark the extent of the Maratha empire in 1759.